Lecture # 4

Individual Attitude and Behavior

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Learning Objectives

After reading this chapter, you should be able to do the following:

1) Identify the major ***work attitudes*** that ***affect*** work behaviors.

2) List the key ***set of behaviors*** that ***matter*** for organizational performance.

3) Understand cross-cultural differences in job attitudes and behaviors at work.


FORTUNE
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Individual Attitude and Behaviour

People Come First: The Case of SAS

- More than 90% of the top 100 companies on the ***Fortune-500*** list are using software developed by SAS(Statistical Analysis System) Institute Inc., the world's largest privately held software company, for their ***business intelligence*** and ***analytical needs***.

- SAS has over 10,000 employees worldwide, operate in over ***100 countries***, and reported $2.31 billion in revenue in 2009 (their 33rd consecutive year of growth and profitability).

- The company is quick to attribute their success to the performance and loyalty of their workforce. This is directly correlated with ***how they treat*** their ***employees***.

People Come First: The Case of SAS

- **SAS** (Statistical Analysis System)has perfected the art of ***employee management***. It has been ranked on Fortune magazine's best places to work list every year since the list was first published.

- Employees seem to genuinely enjoy working at **SAS** and are unusually ***attached to*** the ***company***, resulting in a turnover rate that is less than 4% in an industry where 20% is the norm.

- When Google designed their own legendary campus in California, they visited the SAS campus to get ideas.

People Come First: The Case of SAS

- **SAS** does well is giving its employees opportunities to work on ***interesting*** and ***challenging projects***.
- **SAS** makes an effort to concentrate its business in the areas of analytics, which add the most value and help organizations best analyze disparate data for decision making, creating opportunities for SAS workers to be challenged.
- **SAS** removes obstacles for employees. Equipment, policies, rules, and meetings that could impede productivity are eliminated.

People Come First: The Case of SAS

- SAS wants to eliminate stressors and anything that dissatisfies from people's lives.

- To keep employees ***healthy*** and ***fit***, there are
  - Athletic fields; a full gym
  - A swimming pool; and tennis, basketball
  - Racquet ball courts on campus

  - SAS offers free on-site health care for employees
  - Covers dependents at their fully staffed primary medical care center
  - Offers unlimited sick leave

People Come First: The Case of SAS

- The company understands that employees have a life and encourages employees to work reasonable hours and then ***go home*** to their families.

- Famous motto in the company is, “If you are working for more than 8 hours, you are just ***adding bugs***.”

- SAS is truly one of the industry leaders in leveraging its ***treatment*** of ***people*** for continued business success.

Work Attitudes

Work Attitudes

- Our behavior at work often depends on ***how we feel*** about being there. How people behave depends on understanding their ***work attitudes***.
- An attitude refers to our opinions, beliefs, and feelings about ***aspects*** of ***our environment***.
- We have attitudes toward
  - the food we eat
  - People we interact with
  - Courses we take
  - and various other things
- At work, two particular job attitudes have the greatest potential to influence how we behave. These are ***job satisfaction*** and ***organizational commitment***.

Work Attitudes

- ***Job satisfaction*** refers to the ***feelings*** people have toward ***their job***. Job satisfaction is probably the most important job attitude.
- ***Organizational commitment*** is the emotional attachment people have toward the company they work for.
- There is a high degree of overlap between job satisfaction and organizational commitment, because things that make us happy with our job often make us more committed to the company as well.
- Companies believe that these attitudes are worth tracking because they are often associated with important outcomes such as performance, helping others, absenteeism, and turnover.

How strong is the attitude-behavior link?

- ***First of all,*** it depends on the *attitude* in question.
- Your attitudes toward your colleagues may influence whether you actually help them on a project, but they may not be a good predictor of whether you will quit your job.
- ***Second***, it is worth noting that attitudes are more strongly related to intentions to behave in a certain way, rather than actual behaviors.

Work Attitudes

When you are dissatisfied with your job, you may have the intention to leave.

- Whether you will actually leave is a different story!

  Your leaving will depend on many factors
  - such as availability of alternative jobs in the market
  - your employability in a different company
  - and sacrifices you have to make while changing jobs

- Attitudes give us hints about how a person might behave,
- it is important to remember that ***behavior*** is also strongly influenced by ***situational constraints***.

OB Toolbox: How can you be Happier at Work?

- ***Have a positive attitude about it***. Your personality is a big part of your happiness.
  - If you are always looking for the negative side of everything, you will find it.
- ***A good fit with the job and company is important to your happiness***. This starts with knowing yourself:
  - What do you want from the job?
  - What do you enjoy doing?
  - Be honest with yourself and do a self-assessment.



- ***Get accurate information about the job and the company***. Ask detailed questions about what life is like in this company.
  - Do your research: Read about the company, and use your social network to understand the company's culture.

OB Toolbox: How can you be Happier at Work?

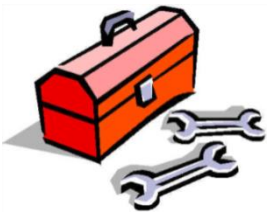


- ***Develop good relationships at work***. Make friends. Try to get a mentor.
  - Approach a person you admire and attempt to build a relationship with this person.
  - An experienced mentor can be a great help in navigating life at a company.
  - Your social network can help you weather the bad days and provide you emotional and instrumental support during your time at the company as well as afterward.

- ***Pay is important, but job characteristics matter more to your job satisfaction***. Don't sacrifice the job itself for a little bit more money.
  - When choosing a job, look at the level of challenge, and the potential of the job to make you engaged.

OB Toolbox: How can you be Happier at Work?

- **Be proactive in managing organizational life**. If the job is stressful,
  - cope with it by effective time management and
  - having a good social network,
  - as well as being proactive in getting to the source of stress.
  - If you do not have enough direction, ask for it!



- ***Know when to leave***. If the job makes you unhappy over an extended period of time and there is little hope of solving the problems, it may be time to look elsewhere.

What Causes Positive Work Attitudes?

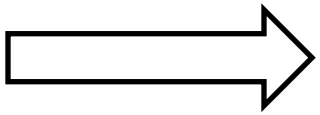
What makes you satisfied with your job
and develop commitment to your company?

- Research shows that people pay attention to several aspects of their work environment,
  - including how they are treated,
  - the relationships they form with colleagues and managers,
  - and the actual work they perform.

- We will now summarize the factors that show consistent relations with ***job satisfaction*** and ***organizational commitment***.

What Causes Positive Work Attitudes?

- Personality
- Person–Environment Fit
- Job Characteristics
- Psychological Contract
- Organizational Justice
- Relationships at Work
- Stress
- Work – Life Balance



Job Satisfaction
Organization Commitment

What Causes Positive Work Attitudes?

- Personality
- Person–Environment Fit
- Job Characteristics
- Psychological Contract
- Organizational Justice
- Relationships at Work
- Stress
- Work – Life Balance

What Causes Positive Work Attitudes?

Personality

Can assessing the ***work environment*** fully explain how satisfied we are on the job?

- Interestingly, some experts have shown that job satisfaction is not purely environmental and is partially due to our ***personality.***
- Some people have a ***disposition to be happy*** in life and at work regardless of environmental factors.
- People who have a ***positive affective disposition*** (those who have a tendency to experience positive moods more often) tend to be ***more satisfied*** with their jobs and more committed to their companies.
- While those who have a ***negative disposition*** tend to be less satisfied and less committed.

What Causes Positive Work Attitudes?

Person–Environment Fit

- The fit between what we bring to our work environment and the environmental demands influences our work attitudes.

- Therefore, ***person–job fit*** and ***person–organization fit*** are positively related to job satisfaction and commitment.

- When our ***abilities match*** job demands and ***our values*** match company values, we tend to be more satisfied with our job and more committed to the company we work for.

What Causes Positive Work Attitudes?

Job Characteristics

- The presence of ***certain characteristics*** on the job seems to make employees ***more satisfied*** and ***more committed***.

- Using a variety of skills
  - having autonomy at work
  - receiving feedback on the job
  - and performing a significant task
- are some job characteristics that are related to satisfaction and commitment.

- Some people expect their jobs to help them ***build new skills*** and improve as an employee.
- These people tend to be more satisfied when their jobs have these characteristics.

What Causes Positive Work Attitudes?

Psychological Contract

- After accepting a job, people come to work with a set of ***expectations***.
- They have an understanding of their responsibilities and rights. In other words, they have a ***psychological contract*** with the company.
- Psychological contract is an ***unwritten understanding*** about what the employee will bring to the work environment and what the company will provide in exchange.

What Causes Positive Work Attitudes?

Psychological Contract

- When people do not get what they expect, they experience a ***psychological contract breach***, which leads to low job satisfaction and commitment.
- Suppose you were told before being hired that the company has ***friendly environment***. After one week you realized that is otherwise (not friendly).
- You are likely to experience a ***breach*** in your psychological contract and be dissatisfied.
- One way of preventing such problems is for companies to provide realistic job previews to their employees.

What Causes Positive Work Attitudes?

Organizational Justice (fairness)

- A strong influence over our satisfaction level is ***how fairly*** we are treated.

- People pay attention to the fairness of
  - Company policies and procedures
  - Treatment from supervisors
  - Salary and other rewards they receive

What Causes Positive Work Attitudes?

Relationships at Work

- Two strong predictors of our happiness at work and commitment to the company are our ***relationships with coworkers*** and managers.

- Important factors our happiness at work
  - People we interact with, their degree of ***kindness***,
  - Level of ***social acceptance*** in our work group
  - Whether we are ***treated with respect***

- Research also shows that our relationship with our manager, are critically important to our job satisfaction and organizational commitment.
  - how considerate the our manager is,
  - whether we build a ***trust-based*** relationship with our manager

What Causes Positive Work Attitudes?

Relationships at Work

- When our manager and upper management listen to us, care about us, and value our opinions, we tend to ***feel good*** at work.
- Even small actions may show employees that the management ***cares*** about them.

Example: Hotel Carlton in San Francisco was recently taken over by a ***new management*** group.

- One of the small things the new management did created dramatic results.
- In response to an employee attitude survey, they replaced the old vacuum cleaners housekeepers were using and established a policy of replacing them every year.
- This simple act of listening to employee problems and taking action went a long way to making employees feel that the ***management cares*** about them.

What Causes Positive Work Attitudes?

Stress

- Not surprisingly, the ***amount of stress*** present in our job is related to our satisfaction and commitment.

- Following are all stressors that make ***people dissatisfied***.
  - Experiencing role ambiguity (vagueness in relation to what our responsibilities are)
  - Role conflict (facing contradictory demands at work)
  - Organizational politics
  - Worrying about the security of our job

What Causes Positive Work Attitudes?

Work–Life Balance

- In modern times, more employees expect to lead balanced lives, pursue hobbies, and spend more time with their children while at the same time continuing to succeed at work.
- The notion of ***work–family conflict*** is one cause of ***job dissatisfaction***.
- When work life interferes with family life, we are ***more stressed*** and unhappy with our jobs.
- Research shows that policies that help employees achieve a ***balance between*** their work and personal lives, are related to higher job satisfaction.

Consequences of Positive Work Attitudes

Why do we care about the job satisfaction and organizational commitment of employees?

What behaviors would you expect to see from someone who has more positive work attitudes?

- It seems that ***happy workers*** have an inclination to be more engaged at work.
  - They may want to perform better
  - They may be more motivated

Work Behaviors

Work Behaviors

- One of the important objectives of the field of organizational behavior is to understand why ***people behave*** the ***way they do***.

- We will focus on ***four work behaviors***:
  - Job performance,
  - Organizational citizenship behaviors,
  - Absenteeism,
  - Turnover

- These are not the ***only behaviors*** OB is concerned about, but understanding what is meant by these terms and understanding the major influences over each type of behavior will give you more clarity about analyzing the behaviors of others in the workplace.

Work Behaviors

Research findings about the causes of each type of behavior in the following figure.

Job Performance	Citizenship	Absenteeism	Turnover
General mental abilities	How we are treated at work	Health problem	Poor Performance
How we are treated at work	Personality	Work/life balance issues	Positive work attitudes (-)
Stress (-)	Positive work attitudes	Positive work attitudes (-)	Stress
Positive work attitude	Age of the employee	Age of the employee (-)	Personality
Personality			Age & tenure of the employee (-)

Work Behaviors

- Job Performance (Appraisal)
- Organizational Citizenship Behaviors
- Absenteeism
- Turnover

Work Behaviors

Job Performance (Appraisal)

- Job performance, or in-role performance, refers to the performance level on factors included in the job description.
- For each job, the content of job performance may differ.
- ***Measures*** of job performance include
  - Quality and quantity of work performed by the employee
  - Accuracy and speed with which the job is performed
  - Overall effectiveness of the person performing the job

Work Behaviors

Job Performance (Appraisal)

- In many companies,
  - Job performance determines whether a person is promoted
  - Rewarded with pay raises
  - Given additional responsibilities
  - or fired from the job

- Therefore, job performance is ***tracked*** and ***observed*** in many organizations and is one of the main outcomes studied in the field of organizational behavior.

Job Performance

- What are major Predictors of ***Job Performance***?
- Under which conditions do people perform well ?
- What are the characteristics of ***high performers***?

- It seems that the most powerful influence over our job performance is our general ***mental ability***, or cognitive abilities.
  - Our reasoning abilities
  - verbal and numerical skills
  - analytical skills
  - and overall intelligence level seems to be important across most situations.

- It seems that general mental ability starts influencing us early in life; it is strongly correlated with measures of academic success.

Job Performance

Following the quality of treatment, the stress we experience determines our performance level.

- When we experience high levels of stress, our mental energies are drained.
- Instead of focusing on the task at hand, we start concentrating on the stressor and become distracted trying to cope with it.
- Because our attention and energies are diverted to deal with stress, our performance suffers.
- Having role ambiguity and experiencing conflicting role demands are related to lower performance.

When we are satisfied with the job, we may perform better

Organizational Citizenship Behaviors

- Organizational citizenship behaviors (OCB) are voluntary behaviors employees performs to help others and benefit the organization.

- Examples of Organizational citizenship behaviors
  - Helping a new co-worker understand how things work in company
  - Volunteering to organize the company picnic
  - Providing suggestions to management about how to improve business processes

- ***These behaviors*** contribute to the smooth operation of business.

Organizational Citizenship Behaviors

What are the major predictors of citizenship behaviors?

- Unlike performance, ***citizenship behaviors*** do not depend so much on one's abilities.
- Job performance, to a large extent, depends on our general mental abilities.
- When you add the education, skills, knowledge, and abilities that are needed to perform well, the role of motivation in performance becomes more limited.
- As a result, someone being motivated will not necessarily translate into a person performing well.
- For citizenship behaviors, the motivation-behavior link is clearer.

We help others around us if we feel motivated to do so.

Organizational Citizenship Behaviors

- Our ***personality*** is yet another explanation for why we perform citizenship behaviors. Personality is a modest predictor of actual job performance but a much better predictor of citizenship.
- Job ***attitudes*** are also moderately related to citizenship behaviors.
- People who are happier at work, those who are more committed to their companies, and those who have overall ***positive attitudes*** toward their work situation tend to perform citizenship behaviors more often than others.
- When people are unhappy, they tend to be disengaged from their jobs and rarely go beyond the minimum that is expected of them.

Absenteeism

- Absenteeism refers to unscheduled ***absences*** from ***work***.
- Absenteeism ***is costly*** to companies because of its unpredictable nature.
- When an employee has an unscheduled absence from work, companies struggle to find replacement workers at the last minute.
- This may involve hiring contingent workers, having other employees work overtime, or scrambling to cover for an absent coworker.

Absenteeism

What causes absenteeism?

- First we need to look at the type of absenteeism.
- Some absenteeism is unavoidable and is related to health reasons.
- For example, reasons such as lower back pain, migraines, accidents on or off the job, or acute stress are important reasons for absenteeism.

Absenteeism

- Health-related absenteeism is costly, but dealing with such absenteeism by using organizational policies penalizing absenteeism is both unreasonable and unfair.
- A sick employee who shows up at work will infect coworkers and will not be productive.
- Instead, companies are finding that programs aimed at keeping workers healthy are effective in dealing with this type of absenteeism.

Absenteeism

- Common reasons for unscheduled absences
  - Staying home to care for a sick child
  - or relative, attending the wedding of a friend
  - or relative, or skipping work to study for an exam

- Having a single ***paid time off*** policy would allow workers to balance work and life, and allow companies to avoid unscheduled absences.

- Some companies such as IBM got rid of sick leave altogether and instead allow employees to take as much time as they need, as long as their work gets done.

OB Toolbox: Dealing with late Co-workers

- ***Try to get to the root cause and find out what is making your coworker unhappy.*** Often, lateness is an extension of dissatisfaction one feels toward the job or tasks at hand.
  - If there are ways in which you can solve these issues, such as by giving the person more responsibility or listening to the opinions of the person and showing more respect, you can minimize lateness.



- ***Make sure that lateness does not go without any negative consequences.*** Do not ignore it, and do not remain silent.
  - Mention carefully and constructively that one person's lateness slows down everyone.

- ***Make an effort to schedule meetings around everyone's schedules***. When scheduling, emphasize the importance of everyone's being there on time and pick a time when everyone can comfortably attend.

OB Toolbox: Dealing with late Co-workers

- ***When people are late***, be sure to ask them to compensate, such as by doing extra work.
  - Negative consequences tend to discourage future lateness.

- ***Shortly before the meeting starts, send everyone a reminder***. Yes, you are dealing with adults and they should keep their own schedules, but some people's schedules may be busier than others, and some are better at keeping track of their time.
  - Reminders may ensure that they arrive on time.



- ***Reward timeliness***. When everyone shows up on time, verbally recognize the effort everyone made to be there on time.

- ***Be on time yourself!*** Creating a culture of timeliness within your group requires everyone's effort, including yours.

Work Behaviors

Turnover

- Turnover refers to an ***employee leaving*** an organization.
- Employee turnover has ***potentially harmful*** consequences, such as poor customer service and poor companywide performance.
- When employees leave, their jobs still need to be performed by someone, so companies spend time recruiting, hiring, and training new employees, all the while suffering from lower productivity. Yet, not all turnover is bad.
- Turnover is particularly a problem when high-performing employees leave, while a poor performer's turnover may actually give the company a chance to improve productivity and morale.

Turnover

Why do employees leave?

- An employee's performance level is an important reason. People who perform poorly are actually more likely to leave.
- These people may be fired or be encouraged to quit, or they may quit because of their fear of being fired.
- If a company has pay-for-performance systems, poor performers will find that they are not earning much, owing to their substandard performance.
- This pay discrepancy gives poor performers an extra incentive to leave.

Work Behaviors

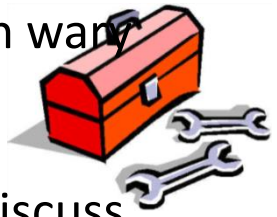
Turnover

- Work attitudes are often the primary culprit in why people leave.
- When workers are unhappy at work, and when they are not attached to their companies, they are more likely to leave.
- Loving the things they do, being happy with the opportunities for advancement within the company, and being happy about pay are all aspects of work attitudes relating to turnover.
- When employees are unhappy, they might have the intention to leave and may start looking for a job, but their ability to actually leave will depend on many factors such as their employability and the condition of the job market.

OB Toolbox: Tips for leaving Job Gracefully

- ***Don't quit on an impulse.*** We all have bad days and feel the temptation to walk away from the job right away. Yet, this is unproductive for your own career. Plan your exit in advance, loo for a better job over an extended period of time, and leave when the moment is right.

- ***Don't quit too often***. While trading jobs in an upward fashion is good, leaving one place and getting another job that is just like the previous one in pay, responsibilities, and position does not help you move forward in your career, and makes you look like a quitter. Companies are often wary of hiring job hoppers.



- ***When you decide to leave***, tell your boss first, and be nice. Don't discuss all the things your manager may have done wrong. Explain your reasons without blaming anyone and frame it as an issue of poor job fit.

OB Toolbox: Tips for leaving Job Gracefully

- ***Do not badmouth your employer***. It is best not to bash the organization you are leaving in front of coworkers. Do not tell them how happy you are to be quitting or how much better your new job looks. There is really no point in making any remaining employees feel bad.

- ***Guard your professional reputation.*** You must realize that the world is a small place. People know others and tales of unprofessional behavior travel quickly to unlikely places.

- ***Finish your ongoing work and don't leave your team in a bad*** spot. Right before a major deadline is probably a bad time to quit. Offer to stay at least 2 weeks to finish your work, and to help hire and train your replacement.



- ***Don't steal from the company!*** Give back all office supplies, keys, ID cards, and other materials. Don't give them any reason to blemish their memory of you. Who knows…you may even want to come back one day.

That is all